Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, March 25, 2024

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on February 20, 2024 be adopted.
CARRIED

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the minutes of the Closed Meeting of Council held on February 20, 2024 be adopted.
CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier invited questions on agenda items from those present.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.1 **Proclamation: Proclamation Request for Save Soil Day – March 21st**

Kiran Manjunath, Volunteer, Conscious Planet, delivered a presentation regarding Conscious Planet – Save Soil, a global movement to save soil.

Mayor Collier presented the proclamation certificate to K. Manjunath and proclaimed March 21, 2024 as Save Soil Day in the Town of Ajax.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked K. Manjunath for his delegation.

5.2 **Presentation: Updates on Blue Box transition and Expanded Green Bin**

Andrew Evans, Director of Waste Management, The Regional Municipality of Durham and Peter Veiga, Manager of Waste Management Operations, The Regional Municipality of Durham, delivered a presentation regarding updates on Durham's transition to Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) and Organics Program Changes.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. P. Veiga and A. Evans responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked A. Evans and P. Veiga for their presentation.

5.3 **Delegation: Implementing Program of All-Inclusive Care for Elders (PACE)**

Paul Sharman, Councillor Ward 5, City of Burlington and Region of Halton and President, Halton Community Housing Corporation, delivered a presentation regarding the implementation of a PACE program.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. P. Sharman responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked P. Sharman for his delegation.

6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence items 6.5 and 6.9 for discussion.

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the balance of the report (Items 6.1, 6.2, 6.3, 6.4, 6.6, 6.7, 6.8 and 6.10) dated March 25, 2024 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Item 6.5

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Item 6.5 (“City of Cambridge – Catch and Release”) of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.9

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Item 6.9 (“Town of Aurora – Legislative Amendments to Improve Municipal Codes of Conduct and Enforcement”) of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1. Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

7.1.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee, March 4, 2024

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the Community Affairs & Planning Report dated March 4, 2024 be adopted.

7.2. General Government Committee Report

7.2.1 General Government Committee, March 18, 2024

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the General Government Committee Report dated March 18, 2024 be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 **Summary of Advisory Committee Activities**

Council Members asked questions related to the contents report. Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated March 25, 2024, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 **Departmental Reports**

None

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Members provided updates regarding the proposed 2024 Regional property tax levy noting that the Regional Budget will be presented to Regional Council March 27, 2024.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of March 25, 2024 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 **Calling on the Province to Urgently Increase Ontario Works Rates**

Regional Councillor Lee and Regional Councillor Dies introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

WHEREAS Ontario Works financial assistance rates have been frozen since 2018 and economic challenges and inflationary pressures are disproportionately impacting vulnerable residents by contributing to increasing income insecurity, housing unaffordability, homelessness and food insecurity;

AND WHEREAS a basic income program can ensure a comprehensive and inclusive approach to addressing income inequality and financial instability;

AND WHEREAS Ontario Works recipients receive a $200 income exemption compared to a $1000 income exemption for recipients of the Ontario Disability Support Program;

AND WHEREAS improved financial stability would result in improved social, economic and health outcomes for our community's most vulnerable residents and increase opportunities for vulnerable residents to contribute to and invest in their local economies;

AND WHEREAS the Social Assistance Modernization program was introduced by the province with the intention of reducing the administrative burden on municipal Service System Managers, including the Regional Municipality of Durham, to prioritize efforts to provide intensive stability supports to vulnerable residents;

AND WHEREAS administrative efficiencies for municipalities have not been realized under the Social Assistance Modernization program;

AND WHEREAS the Social Assistance Modernization program has resulted in unintended consequences including delays to processing applications and the elimination of essential

people-centred supports, including bus fares, that are jeopardizing an individuals' ability to transition out of poverty;

AND WHEREAS leadership is urgently needed from the provincial government to develop, resource, and implement a comprehensive and inclusive plan to address increasing levels of poverty for people living in Ontario, and in particular, those receiving Ontario Works;

AND WHEREAS on February 28, 2024, Durham Regional Council ratified a motion urgently calling on the province to increase Ontario Works rates and evaluate the effectiveness of the Social Services Modernization program;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council calls on the provincial government to urgently increase Ontario Works rates to a livable rate and commit to indexing supports to the annual rate of inflation consistent with the Ontario Disability Support Program; and further that the Ontario Works earning exemption be aligned with the Ontario Disability Support Program to allow individuals in the workforce to keep more of their earnings and promote participation in the workforce; and

2. Ajax Council calls on the provincial government to evaluate the effectiveness of the Social Services Modernization program, in consultation with Municipal Service System Managers, and consider the impact that the partial upload of the Ontario Works application process has had on streamlining, efficiencies and maintaining of service standards; and

3. The province restore funding to the Ontario Works program which was eliminated with the transfer of responsibility to the Ministry of Labour, Immigration, Training and Skills Development (MLITSD) Service System Managers to ensure an adequate level of employment services funding is available; and

4. A copy of this motion be sent to the Minister of Children, Community, and Social Services, Minister of Finance, Patrice Barnes, MPP for Ajax, John Henry, Durham Regional Chair, the Association of Municipalities of Ontario, Ontario Big City Mayors and the Ontario Municipal Social Services Association.

CARRIED

9.2 **Supportive Aging in Place Initiatives for Ajax Seniors**

Regional Councillor Dies and Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

WHEREAS the Town of Ajax is facing a rapidly aging population, with the percentage of individuals over 65 making up 13% of the overall population according to the 2021 census data, up from 7.3% in 2001;

AND WHEREAS many Canadians want to age in place in their own home and community, which requires appropriate health and social supports and services to facilitate independent living;

AND WHEREAS the Ministry of Health, through its Home Care Modernization initiative, is seeking innovative in-home care delivery models;

AND WHEREAS the Program of All-Inclusive Care for the Elderly (PACE) model provides a comprehensive medical and social service delivery system using an interdisciplinary team approach to coordinate all preventive, primary, acute and long-term care needs;

AND WHEREAS the PACE model of care is being delivered successfully in other municipalities, including Burlington where the PACE Community Hub is celebrating its fifth anniversary;

AND WHEREAS the PACE model of care is being implemented in Oshawa this year at 155 King Street West;

AND WHEREAS implementation of the PACE program in Ajax would benefit residents, while alleviating demands on local hospitals and related healthcare institutions;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

Ajax Council supports the Region of Durham expanding the PACE program into the Town of Ajax; and,

A copy of this motion be sent to the Honourable Sylvia Jones, Minister of Health, Patrice Barnes, MPP for Ajax, John Henry, Chair of the Regional Municipality of Durham, Durham Regional Health and Social Services Committee, Durham Regional Local Housing Corporation, Ashley Manor Housing Corporation (formerly Ajax Municipal Housing Corporation), all Durham Region lower tier municipalities, Cynthia Davis, President and CEO of Lakeridge Health, the Durham Ontario Health Team, Community Care Durham, and Durham Mental Health Services.

CARRIED

9.3 **Amendments to the Code of Conduct**

Mayor Collier and Regional Councillor Crawford introduced the motion and reviewed its contents. Council Members asked questions related to the motion. N. Cooper responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS section 223.2 (1) of the Municipal Act, 2001, requires municipalities to establish codes of conduct for members of the council of the municipality and of its local boards;

AND WHEREAS certain amendments to the Code of Conduct are desirable for reasons of transparency and to clarify and strengthen expectations of Members of Council;

AND WHEREAS an upper limit of $300.00 for Members who have received a gift or benefit from a single source during a calendar year is not reflective of the inflationary pressures on goods and events;

AND WHEREAS informal resolution of complaints against a Member results in a lack of public transparency and may limit opportunities for Member and Council learning;

AND WHEREAS costs arising from complaints are significant and in the interests of transparency, information regarding complaints should be reported to Council;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. The redline changes to the Code of Conduct and its appendices, as provided in Attachment 1 and Attachment 2, be adopted; and

2. The updated Code of Conduct be presented to Council for approval.

Motion to Defer

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That Council defer consideration of the Notice of Motion respecting Amendments to the Code of Conduct to the April 15, 2024 Council meeting.

CARRIED

Point of Order

Mayor Collier raised a point of order noting that pursuant to section 11.7 of the Council Procedure By-law no Member shall speak to the same question for longer than five minutes.

Point of Privilege

Councillor Henry asked if Members are timed when posing questions. Jason McWilliam, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, responded to the question.

Mayor Collier noted that the Point of Privilege is out of order.

10. By-laws

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law number 17-2024 and By-law numbers 19-2024 to 25-2024 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

Note: By-law 18-2024 has been deferred to the April 15, 2024 Council meeting.

11. Notice of Motion

None

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: S. Lee

That By-law number 26-2024 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on March 25, 2024, be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the March 25, 2024 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (3:08 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

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D-Clerk